

Registering on Tuesday

The time commitment for ISEF judging is a day and a fraction. All judges should plan to be present in the Kay Bailey Hutchison Convention Center Dallas for all judging activities beginning with Registration on Tuesday afternoon through voting for all award decisions Wednesday evening.

However, a small fraction of judges may not be able to fulfill this on-site commitment both Tuesday and Wednesday. It is for these judges that ISEF is offering a mechanism to complete the required Tuesday activities remotely. The Wednesday commitment on-site, however, must be for the entire day, “from dawn to dusk.”

Judges making use of remote registration on Tuesday are not excused from the preparation expected from all judges on Tuesday. Such judges will simply do their Tuesday preparations remotely. Because they will register and do their other Tuesday judging activities through the internet, this mechanism is usually referred to as “Virtual Tuesday.”

We do *not* recommend this mechanism to you if it is at all possible for you to be present in the Dallas Convention Center Tuesday afternoon by 5:00 pm because the off-site judging activities on Tuesday cannot fully reproduce the on-site experience.

Intended Audience

We are offering Virtual Tuesday to serve two distinct classes of judges:

1. Judges who live so far away from the Dallas Convention Center that simply driving to the fair from their homes twice in two days would be an undue hardship, and
2. Judges whose travel plans become disrupted at the last minute, preventing them from arriving at the Dallas Convention Center before registration closes at 5:00 pm.

While we encourage everyone to register on-site on Tuesday, and complete all of the other Tuesday judging activities on-site as well, we will accommodate the needs of judges for whom on-site registration is impossible or an unreasonable burden so that they will still be able to serve as judges on Wednesday.

Judging Activities on Tuesday

Although there will be no student contact until Wednesday, given the quality of student projects that you will see, failing to prepare adequately on Tuesday for each project will render your interviews less productive than the ISEF finalists deserve. When you register on-site on Tuesday, here is a brief description of what you will do.

1. You will physically register on site between noon and 5 pm with appropriate government-issued identification. Registration will then produce your badge with a unique QR code giving you access to all judging areas (project display area and judge meeting rooms).

2. You will receive your personal interview schedule, generated in real time based upon your declared area of expertise and the then-existing schedules of every project in your category.
3. Now that you can enter the project display area, you should review the displays of your assigned projects. This is especially important for those projects where your review demonstrates that additional background research is necessary before speaking with the students.
4. You should also review other project displays in your category in order to identify and select projects that were *not* assigned to you, but which you would nevertheless like to interview on Wednesday. The set of assignments made on Wednesday afternoon for the final two periods will be based on your selections, and those of all other judges, on Tuesday. See document *G: My5 Projects* in section III of the *Judge Information Board* for more information.
5. You will meet your fellow judges in your category. Typically, a single category will have 30-50 judges, so the opportunities to network within your field are significant. You should get to know each other better on Tuesday evening because you will be working with this same set of judges throughout the Fair, most intensely during the caucusing for awards on Wednesday evening.
6. You will meet your category co-chairs.
7. You will attend a training session led by those co-chairs, at which time you can get answers to any questions you still have or that may arise during the training.
8. You will enjoy a catered dinner in your own category's meeting room.
9. Finally, during your discussions with fellow judges, you may discover that others have found certain projects that by their title alone you did not recognize as of special interest to you. The project display area will remain open to you until 9:00 pm.

How Will Virtual Tuesday Replace These Activities?

On-Site Judges	Virtual Tuesday Judges
1. Register on site	Register online between noon and 5 pm Tuesday. You will still need to register on site Wednesday morning, but registering online Tuesday afternoon will give access to the other steps below.
2. Get schedule	You will receive your interview schedule online.
3. Review assigned projects	You will have access to each project's abstract, <i>Project Presentation</i> , QuadChart, and a student-produced video. Obviously, this is not as good as examining the actual project display itself, but it is all we can do through a computer screen.
4. Identify interesting unassigned projects	By viewing student-provided materials, select projects not on your initial schedule which you would like to interview. Your selections affect the assignments generated Wednesday afternoon just as if you were on-site. See <i>G: My5 Projects</i> in section III.
5. Network with fellow judges	This will have to wait until Wednesday.
6. Meet co-chairs	This will have to wait until Wednesday.

On-Site Judges	Virtual Tuesday Judges
7. Training session	A recording of the Tuesday evening training session will be posted to the Judge Information Board in section VI, "Newsletters/Broadcasts" along with a copy of the training slides. If you have questions about the training, you will need to ask them Wednesday morning. (Note: This posting of training materials will not be repeated for either of the Wednesday training sessions.)
8. Dinner with your new-found friends	Sorry, you're on your own.
9. Review projects after dinner pointed out by other judges	While you can still view materials for any project, you won't have the opportunity to learn about interesting projects that other judges discovered and could have told you about during dinner or the informal time accompanying the training session.

As you see, Virtual Tuesday judges will simulate the on-site experience Tuesday where that is possible, though the remote experience can be only a pale shadow of the on-site experience. Further, Virtual Tuesday judges have an additional responsibility to arrive extra early on Wednesday, as we will now explain.

How will Virtual Tuesday judges get in on Wednesday?

Virtual Tuesday judges still need to go through *physical* registration – they will just do so early on Wednesday instead of Tuesday afternoon.

Access to the judging areas (project display area and judge meeting rooms) requires judges to have name badges exhibiting a valid QR code. In order to get your coded name badge **you will need to arrive at the Convention Center early on Wednesday morning**. This means that you will then go through the same physical registration process, including checking your government-issued ID, that all other judges did on Tuesday.

Wednesday morning you will have to come early. Exactly how early is "early" is unknown, nor how long it will take to shuttle all Virtual Tuesday judges through the entire physical registration process. It takes all Tuesday afternoon to process all other judges, so plan on arriving sufficiently early that you don't miss the Wednesday breakfast meeting and training session with your fellow judges.

Even better, if you arrive early enough, you will have a brief opportunity to view the project displays (and only the displays) between 7:00 am and 7:40 am. The display area opens at 7:00 am, but all Grand Award judges must leave that area by 7:40 am so that Special Award judges will have unfettered access to the students then arriving for interviews. *This is the only time Special Award judges have clear access to all students.* Beginning with Interview Period 1, and for the rest of the day, Grand Award judges with a scheduled interview have priority over all other judges. See the document *I: Interview Conflicts with Other Judges* in section III of the *Judge Information Board* for a more complete explanation of priority.

What If I'm "Just a Little Late" on Tuesday?

In all cases, ***you must still register between noon and 5:00 pm on Tuesday***. If you find that you will arrive at Registration after 5:00 pm, you will need to take advantage of Virtual Tuesday's registration. For example, if your plane suffers a delay that will cause you to be late, you must register online. Similarly, if you are stuck on the freeway at 4:30 pm, pull over to the shoulder and register online before continuing on to the Convention Center.

If I Do Virtual Tuesday Registration, Can I Still Come Tuesday Night?

Yes, and we recommend that you *do* come Tuesday night if that is possible, even after registering remotely. There will be a late skeleton crew at Registration until 9:00 pm. They will be able to check your identification and give you your name badge and other materials so that you will not then have to arrive extra early on Wednesday morning. If you come Tuesday evening, there will even be the opportunity to view the projects until the display area closes at 9:00 pm.

However, this late skeleton crew will *not* be able to accommodate you if you did not register online before 5:00 pm and receive your interview schedule at that time. There is no opportunity to generate late interview schedules Tuesday evening because the student version of the judge interview schedules will then be being printed and delivered to project displays.

IMPORTANT: All Judges Must Register on Tuesday

This means *all* judges. Judges who come to the fair on Wednesday, without having registered on Tuesday (and are thus without an interview schedule) will be turned away.

Points of Emphasis

1. Virtual Tuesday is intended *only* for judges for whom coming to the Dallas Convention Center on Tuesday before 5 pm is either impossible or an undue hardship.
2. Judges utilizing this facility are still responsible for remotely completing all of the same judging activities on Tuesday that they would have completed if they were on-site.
3. Virtual Tuesday judges must arrive extra early on Wednesday morning in order to complete the physical registration process. Alternatively, Virtual Tuesday registrants may arrive Tuesday evening to complete the physical registration process.
4. There is no exception to the requirement for judges to register between noon and 5 pm Tuesday.